

HR APPLICANT PROCESS WINDOWS APPLICATION

User Manual

BSIT 1-1 [Group 9] COMP 003 Capstone Project

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For Applicants and HR Personnel

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1. INTRODUCTION

The HR Applicant Process Windows Application is a desktop program built using C# and MySQL. It is designed to manage the full hiring process from the moment a job applicant registers, all the way to the final hiring decision.

There are three types of users in this system:

- Applicant - Can register, log in, fill in their profile, apply for a job, upload documents, and track their application status.
- HR Staff - Can review applicant submissions, screen applicants, schedule interviews, and record interview results.
- HR Manager / Admin - Has all HR Staff abilities, plus can make the final hiring decision, manage job vacancies, manage HR user accounts, and generate reports.

2. SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Before using the application, make sure the following are set up:

- Operating System: Windows 10 or Windows 11
- Database: MySQL (must be running on your computer)
- Database Name: hr_applicant_process_window_application
- Default Database Username: root
- Default Database Password: 1234
- Language/Framework: C# Windows Forms (.NET Framework)

IMPORTANT: MySQL must be running before you open the application. If MySQL is off, the system will show a database connection error.

3. GETTING STARTED - MAIN LOGIN SCREEN

When you open the application, the first screen you see is the General Login Screen. It has two buttons:

- Applicant - Click this if you are applying for a job.
- Human Resources - Click this if you are HR Staff, HR Manager, or Admin.

Make sure you click the correct button. Each one leads to a different login screen.

4. APPLICANT GUIDE

4.1 CREATING AN ACCOUNT (REGISTRATION)

If you do not have an account yet, follow these steps:

Step 1 - On the Applicant Login screen, click the Register button.

Step 2 - Fill in your Email Address, Password, and Confirm Password.

Step 3 - Make sure your email has the correct format (example: `juan@email.com`).

Step 4 - Make sure your Password and Confirm Password are exactly the same.

Step 5 - Click the Create button.

Step 6 - A success message will appear if the account was created.

Possible error messages:

- "Please fill in all the fields." - You left something empty.
 - "Passwords do not match." - Re-type your password carefully.
 - "Please enter a valid email address." - Check the format of your email.
 - "Email already exists." - Use a different email or log in instead.
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4.2 LOGGING IN

Step 1 - On the Applicant Login screen, enter your Email and Password.

Step 2 - Click the Login button.

Step 3 - If correct and your account is Active, you will go to your Dashboard.

Note: *If you see "Invalid email/password or account inactive", your account may have been deactivated. Contact the Admin.*

4.3 APPLICANT DASHBOARD

After logging in, you will see your Dashboard. This is your summary page. It shows:

- Current Status - What stage your application is at right now.
 - Interview Schedule - If an interview was scheduled, the date and time appear here.
 - Missing Documents - A reminder of documents you have not submitted yet.
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4.4 MY PROFILE

This is where you enter your personal information. Fill in all sections:

- Personal Information: Full name, date of birth, gender, civil status, nationality.
- Address: Your current home address.
- Contact: Phone number or other contact details.
- Education: School, degree, year graduated.
- Skills: Relevant skills for the job.
- Work Experience: Previous jobs, company name, position, dates.

Step 1 - Click My Profile from the menu.

Step 2 - Fill in all the fields.

Step 3 - Click Save or Update.

Note: *You can update your profile at any time. But once HR starts reviewing your application, the application itself will be locked and cannot be edited.*

4.5 JOB VACANCIES

This page shows all open job positions.

Step 1 - Click Job Vacancies from the menu.

Step 2 - Browse the list of available jobs (shows Position, Department, Employment Type).

Step 3 - Click on a job you want to apply for.

Step 4 - Click the Apply button.

Rules:

- You can only apply for jobs with an OPEN status.
- You cannot apply for the same job twice. The system will block it.

4.6 MY APPLICATION

After applying, this page shows your application details:

- Job position applied for
- Department and employment type
- Current application status
- Last update date

Application Status meanings:

- Draft - Started but not yet submitted. You can still edit.
 - Submitted - Submitted, HR has not reviewed yet. Minor edits are still allowed.
 - Under Review - HR is reviewing. You CANNOT edit anymore.
 - Shortlisted - You passed the first review.
 - For Interview - An interview has been scheduled for you.
 - For Assessment - You need to take an exam.
 - For Final Review - Waiting for the HR Manager's final decision.
 - Accepted - You are hired!
 - Rejected - Application was not successful.
 - Withdrawn - Application was cancelled.
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4.7 MY DOCUMENTS

This page shows the documents required for your applied job and their status.

- Submitted - You already uploaded this document.
- Missing - You have not submitted this yet.

Step 1 - Click My Documents from the menu.

Step 2 - Find documents with "Missing" status.

Step 3 - Click the document and use the Upload or Record button to submit it.

Step 4 - The status will change to "Submitted" once done.

Note: *You can replace documents as long as HR has not locked your application.*

4.8 APPLICATION STATUS

This page shows the full timeline of your application with dates and times. Every time your status changes, it is recorded here in order.

You can also see HR remarks and your interview schedule on this page.

4.9 CHANGE PASSWORD

Step 1 - Go to Change Password (from Dashboard or account settings).

Step 2 - Enter your current password.

Step 3 - Enter a new password.

Step 4 - Re-enter the new password in Confirm Password.

Step 5 - Click Save or Confirm.

Note: *If the new password and confirm password do not match, nothing will be saved.*

5. HR PERSONNEL GUIDE

5.1 HR LOGIN

Step 1 - From the General Login Screen, click Human Resources.

Step 2 - Enter your email and password.

Default HR Manager: hrma@gmail.com / password123

Default HR Staff: hrs@gmail.com / password456

Step 3 - Click Login.

Step 4 - You will be taken to your dashboard based on your role.

5.2 HR STAFF DASHBOARD

Shows a summary of recruitment activity:

- Total number of open job vacancies
 - Quick access to Applicant List, Job Vacancy Management, and other sections
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5.3 HR MANAGER / ADMIN DASHBOARD

Has all HR Staff features plus:

- Access to database table inspection
 - Reports generation
 - Final Hiring Decision
 - User management (adding HR accounts)
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5.4 JOB VACANCY MANAGEMENT

Adding a New Job Vacancy:

Step 1 - Go to Job Vacancy Management.

Step 2 - Select the Department.

Step 3 - Select the Employment Type.

Step 4 - Select the Position Type.

Step 5 - Check the required Qualifications.

Step 6 - Check the required Documents applicants must submit.

Step 7 - Set Status to "Open".

Step 8 - Click Save.

Closing a Job:

Step 1 - Find the job in the list.

Step 2 - Change Status to "Closed".

Step 3 - Save changes.

Note: *Closed jobs cannot receive new applications.*

5.5 APPLICANT LIST

Shows all applicants who submitted applications.

- Search by name using the Search box.
- Filter by status using the Status dropdown.

From here, HR can open an applicant to Review, Screen, Schedule Interview, or Evaluate, depending on the applicant's current stage.

5.6 APPLICANT REVIEW

Step 1 - Select an applicant from the Applicant List.

Step 2 - The Applicant Review screen opens showing their full details.

Step 3 - Review their name, position, education, skills, work experience, and documents.

Step 4 - Click Lock for Review to begin the official review.

Step 5 - Status changes to "Under Review". The applicant can no longer edit.

Note: *Locking is permanent for that stage. It is also recorded in the Audit Trail.*

5.7 SCREENING

Step 1 - Open an applicant (using the Screening option).

Step 2 - Check if they meet the job qualifications.

Step 3 - Select: Qualified or Not Qualified.

Step 4 - Write screening remarks.

Step 5 - Click Save.

- Qualified → Applicant moves forward to interview stage.
 - Not Qualified → Application process ends. Status updates to Rejected.
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5.8 INTERVIEW SCHEDULING

Step 1 - Select the applicant from the Applicant List.

Step 2 - Choose Interview Scheduling.

Step 3 - Pick the Interview Date and Time (must be a future date).

Step 4 - Select the Interviewer from the dropdown.

Step 5 - Enter Mode/Location (e.g., "Online via Zoom" or "Room 2").

Step 6 - Set Status to "Scheduled".

Step 7 - Click Save.

Note: *Past dates will be rejected by the system.*

Interview statuses:

- Scheduled - Interview is set. Visible on applicant's Dashboard.
 - Completed - Interview was conducted.
 - Cancelled - Interview was cancelled.
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5.9 INTERVIEW EVALUATION

Step 1 - Select the applicant (using Interview Evaluation option).

Step 2 - Enter the Score (numerical rating of the interview).

Step 3 - Enter Remarks (notes about the interview).

Step 4 - Enter Recommendations (suggested next steps).

Step 5 - Select Result: Pass or Fail.

Step 6 - Click Save.

5.10 FINAL HIRING DECISION (HR MANAGER / ADMIN ONLY)

IMPORTANT: Only HR Manager / Admin can do this. HR Staff cannot.

Step 1 - Go to the Hiring Decision screen.

Step 2 - You will see applicants with status "For Final Review".

Step 3 - Select an applicant.

Step 4 - Choose the Decision: Accepted, Rejected, or On Hold.

Step 5 - Enter Final Remarks.

Step 6 - Click Submit Decision.

Outcomes:

- Accepted - Applicant is hired. Status becomes "Accepted".
- Rejected - Application ends. Status becomes "Rejected".
- On Hold - No decision yet. Applicants stay in consideration.

5.11 REPORTS (HR MANAGER / ADMIN)

Available reports:

- Applicant List Report - All applicants and their current status.
- Pending Applications - Applications still waiting for a decision.
- Interviews Report - All scheduled and completed interviews.
- Accepted/Rejected Report - Summary of final decisions.
- Missing Requirements Report - Applicants with missing documents.

Step 1 - Go to Reports from the dashboard.

Step 2 - Select the report type.

Step 3 - View the data on screen.

Step 4 - Print or Export as needed.

5.12 MAINTENANCE (ADMIN ONLY)

Manage dropdown values used in the system:

- Departments - Add/edit department names (IT, Finance, Marketing, etc.)
- Position Types - Add/edit job positions (Manager, Assistant, etc.)
- Employment Types - Full-time, Part-time, Contractual, etc.
- Requirement Types - Document types required from applicants.
- Interview Types - Types of interviews (Panel, One-on-one, etc.)
- Assessment Types - Types of exams or assessments.

6. APPLICATION STATUS FLOW

(FULL JOURNEY)

- Step 1** - Applicant registers and creates account. (Applicant)
- Step 2** - Applicant fills in their profile. (Applicant)
- Step 3** - Applicant views open jobs and applies. (Applicant)
- Step 4** - Applicant uploads required documents. (Applicant)
- Step 5** - HR Staff reviews and locks the application → Status: Under Review. (HR Staff)
- Step 6** - HR Staff screens the applicant: Qualified or Not Qualified. (HR Staff)
- Step 7** - If Qualified, HR schedules an interview → Status: For Interview. (HR Staff)
- Step 8** - HR records interview results (score, remarks, pass/fail). (HR Staff)
- Step 9** - Application moves to For Final Review. (HR Staff)
- Step 10** - HR Manager makes final decision: Accepted, Rejected, or On Hold. (HR Manager)
- Step 11** - Applicant sees the final result in their Application Status page. (Applicant)

7. TROUBLESHOOTING

Problem: App does not open / shows database error.

Fix: Make sure MySQL is running. Check that the database exists and password is 1234.

Problem: Cannot log in as Applicant.

Fix: Check email and password. Account may be Inactive - contact Admin.

Problem: Cannot log in as HR.

Fix: Default HR Staff is hrs@gmail.com / password456. Contact Admin for new accounts.

Problem: Cannot edit my application.

Fix: Once HR locks the application, editing is disabled by design.

Problem: Applied for a job but it does not appear in My Application.

Fix: Check if you actually clicked Submit. Status should say "Submitted" not "Draft".

Problem: Document still shows as Missing after uploading.

Fix: Make sure you clicked Save after uploading. Re-upload if needed.

Problem: HR Staff cannot accept an applicant.

Fix: Only HR Manager / Admin can accept. Log in with an HR Manager account.

Problem: Interview date was rejected.

Fix: The date must be in the future. Past dates are not allowed.

8. GLOSSARY

Application - The form submitted by a job applicant for a specific job position.

Applicant - A person applying for a job in the system.

Status - The current stage of an application (Draft, Submitted, Accepted, etc.).

Draft - An unfinished, unsubmitted application.

Locked - An application that can no longer be edited by anyone.

Audit Trail - A hidden log of all important actions done in the system.

Screening - HR checking if an applicant meets basic job requirements.

Shortlisted - Applicant passed the initial review and moves to the next stage.

Interview Evaluation - The score and notes given by HR after an interview.

Hiring Decision - The final choice: Accepted, Rejected, or On Hold.

Maintenance - Admin section for managing dropdown values (departments, positions, etc.).

Role - The type of user account: Applicant, HR Staff, or HR Manager / Admin.

Requirement / Document - A file applicants must submit (Resume, ID, Transcript, etc.).

Missing Requirement - A required document that has not been submitted yet.